campaigner for civil rights. Her 1947 book *The Everglades: River of Grass* was influential in building an appreciation of the Florida wetlands, and in 1969 she founded the Friends of the Everglades to defend the area from draining for development. Douglas remained active well into her second century, and at the age of 103 she was awarded the Presidential Medal of Freedom.

See also: Citizen science

BARBARA McCLINTOCK

1902–1992

In 1983 McClintock became the first solo woman to win the Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine, and the first American woman to win any unshared Nobel Prize. The award recognized her discovery—more than 30 years before—of transposable genetic elements, or "jumping genes," which sometimes create or reverse mutations. As a cytogeneticist concerned with how chromosomes relate to cell behavior, she also discovered the first genetic map for corn—linking physical traits with regions of the chromosome—and the mechanism by which chromosomes exchange information.

See also: The role of DNA

JACQUES COUSTEAU

1910–1997

French undersea explorer Cousteau was well known as the presenter of several documentaries on the aquatic world. After inventing underwater breathing apparatus called the Aqua-Lung in 1943, he worked with the French Navy to clear underwater mines after World War II. He later converted the *Calypso*, a former minesweeper, into a research vessel from which he explored the oceans, writing several books and making hours of